

3, Perspectives on the "Fascist States" of Germany and Japan

The terminology I employ here is admittedly controversial. Mainland China tends to indiscriminately label all three major Axis powers as "Fascist states," yet most informed individuals are aware that a considerable typological gap exists between Japan and genuine Fascist states. The existence of this discrepancy is inevitable. Japan's process of **feudalization** (封建化) commenced significantly later than that of Western Europe, although its pace of catching up was remarkably rapid throughout most of its history. However, during the **early modern period** (近世社会), due to its relative geographical isolation and the fact that its neighbors were **restoration-bureaucratic states** (复辟官僚国家), Japan's social development encountered certain impediments. By the first half of the 20th century, the "**modernity**" (现代性) possessed by Japan—namely, the unique social, cultural, political, and economic characteristics inherent to a modern society—was still less pronounced than that of Germany and Italy. Consequently, in terms of features such as extreme nationalism, Fascist one-party dictatorship, personal autocracy, and a mass-based, unified Fascist ideology, Japan between 1931 and 1945 could hardly be classified as a true Fascist state. Regardless of whatever typological gaps existed between Japan and Germany or Italy at the time, it does not preclude me from discussing them as an integrated whole here. That is to say, the distinctly styled "Fascist regimes" of these three nations were all forged under the conditions of having fully undergone the process of **feudalization**, but with insufficient development of capitalism. Therefore, for the sake of categorization, I will forgo further differentiation and adopt the generalized terminology utilized in mainland China.

For youths across the globe, at an age when their worldviews are yet to mature, the most captivating aspect of history is invariably the history of human warfare and the tales of heroes who achieved extraordinary feats in battle. Naturally, I was no exception. Be it novels about the Second World War, the memoirs of participating generals and leaders, or even the illustrated encyclopedias of military equipment that children adore, I indeed devoured a great deal of them. However, as I grew older and my own level of cognitive awareness gradually elevated, my perplexities surrounding the Second World War multiplied.

A quintessential example is that Germany and Japan, even during their periods of horrific Fascist rule, exhibited societal characteristics vastly distinct from those of the Soviet Union and Chinese (the current regime) societies. As my understanding of Chinese society deepened, this profound discrepancy inevitably captured my attention. For instance, in Nazi Germany, even a high-ranking official at the ministerial level would insist on appending "Doctor" (Dr.) to his title, provided he held a doctoral degree. The most representative figure in this regard is undeniably Hitler's loyal fanatic and one of the most powerful individuals in Nazi Germany, Paul Joseph Goebbels. Even in Chinese translations, he is generally referred to as "Reich Minister of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda of Nazi Germany, Dr. Goebbels." Although I knew—even without understanding German or ever having visited Germany—that German academic degrees, especially doctorates, were exceptionally difficult to attain, the immense value and profound pride these high-ranking Nazi bureaucrats attached to their doctoral degrees still utterly astounded me.

In "party-bureaucratic" countries such as the Soviet Union and China, while one cannot claim that academic credentials are entirely useless, in an environment where one's status within the **bureaucratic system** (官僚体制) plays the absolute decisive role in the distribution of social wealth, an academic degree is completely negligible when placed before an official rank. According to the

established conventions of our bureaucratic society, even at the relatively low level of Section Chief (科长), "Doctor" can no longer serve as the primary title. This means that if a section-level cadre within the Chinese bureaucratic system simultaneously holds a doctoral degree, people will almost certainly address him as "Section Chief So-and-so"; only under highly specific circumstances would anyone highlight his doctoral degree. For ranks above the section level, it goes without saying. Only in formal official introductions are educational backgrounds and highest degrees presented prominently, but in reality, few people pay attention to them, and practically no one takes them seriously.

In a certain sense, this is also because the absolute dominance of the bureaucracy naturally encompasses academic degrees. In countries like ours and the former Soviet Union, once you have become a high-ranking bureaucrat, acquiring a degree requires virtually zero effort. Ironically enough, precisely because academic credentials command so little respect in these countries to begin with, some individuals, despite possessing immense power, cannot even be bothered to obtain a degree for the sake of window dressing. It was precisely as my social experience grew that I increasingly felt the behavior of individuals like Goebbels, who placed such immense value on their academic credentials, to be utterly bizarre. (Of course, I am well aware that the truly bizarre entity is myself; compared to Germany—even the Germany under Nazi rule—the society in which I reside is vastly more anomalous.)

As Japan was one of the two nations (the other being Russia) that inflicted the greatest catastrophic invasions upon China since the modern era, and as it was our nation's direct adversary throughout the anti-Fascist war, civil discourse within China regarding Fascist Japan far exceeds discussions about Nazi Germany. However, it is a profoundly tragic reality that, compared to the attitude Chinese people *ought* to adopt—being anti-Japanese Fascism but not anti-Japan—it is blatantly obvious that my compatriots much prefer being anti-Japan while not being anti-Fascist. The fanatical propaganda slogans coined by the Japanese invaders during the so-called "Greater East Asia War," as well as the insubordinate "gekokujo" (下克上 / acting independently without orders) behaviors of the radical junior officers, are widely idolized among restless and ignorant peers of my generation. In fact, the moment I open any social media platform dominated by young users, it takes less than five minutes to encounter such intellectually deficient articles or videos.

Although I am disgusted by this, such a massive bombardment of information gradually made me realize that Fascist Japan—the regime most loathed by the Chinese people—actually possessed certain characteristics that I had never noticed before, characteristics starkly different from those of states like China and the Soviet Union. Astonishingly, the Japanese exhibited a profound reverence for the law, even well before their post-war democratic reforms. The most striking manifestation of this is that the *Constitution of the Empire of Japan* (commonly referred to as the "Meiji Constitution"), after its formal promulgation in early 1889 until it was replaced by the "Peace Constitution" post-war, underwent absolutely no substantive amendments. The Japanese government only adjusted the interpretation and implementation of specific clauses. This implies that even during the period when the Japanese military harbored overwhelming power, when Fascist political organizations like the Imperial Rule Assistance Association could dictate national politics, and when the Japanese Empire's war of aggression was rapidly expanding, Japanese Fascists did not attempt to amend the Constitution. Instead, they merely fortified their control over the entire nation through the addition of various wartime decrees.

During the infamous "February 26 Incident," when radical junior officers of the Imperial Way Faction launched a coup d'état demanding that the Emperor bypass the "traitors to the nation" and assume direct personal rule, Emperor Hirohito surprisingly expressed extreme fury toward the coup. He emphasized that by realizing the "imperial sanctioning of all state affairs" (万机御亲裁) under the Meiji constitutional system, he was already exercising direct rule, and no other form of direct rule could exist.

If one does not simultaneously understand the histories of both China and Japan, it is exceedingly difficult to comprehend the absolute shock I—as someone who has lived in China for an extended period—feel toward this. In our country, it is virtually unimaginable for a ruler not to exploit such a "pro-emperor coup," but rather immediately decide to suppress it. If one still cannot grasp this "bizarreness" of Japanese society, one only needs to observe the contemporary phenomenon in the vast non-democratic nations of the Third World where constitutions lack any binding force whatsoever, and see how effortlessly these countries amend their constitutions.

As for the Soviet Union and Soviet-style states, it goes without saying. The constitutions enacted by these regimes can be altered on a whim. They can declare they have bypassed whatever historical stage they wish to bypass, and proclaim whatever ideology they desire as their guiding ideology. Even if we confine our gaze to the Fascist or extreme right-wing nations that rose during that turbulent era, the degree to which Japan's original constitution was undermined was still relatively minor (of course, this is also related to the incompleteness of the Meiji Restoration; after all, the power granted to the Emperor in the Meiji Constitution was already immense).

Under Salazar's rule, Portugal enacted a new constitution in 1933; Romania enacted a new constitution in 1938; Miklós Horthy's regency in Hungary lacked a formal constitutional text; Spain under Franco did not enact a new constitution; and the Tsardom of Bulgaria amended the constitution from its early days of independence. Italy under Mussolini did not abolish its original constitution (the Statuto Albertino enacted during the Kingdom of Sardinia) but effectively suspended its implementation and fascistized the state through supplementary decrees. The Third Reich under Hitler drastically amended the original Weimar Republic Constitution and gradually realized a Fascist dictatorship through a series of laws, such as the *Enabling Act* of 1933, the *Law Concerning the Highest State Office of the Reich* of 1934, and the *Nuremberg Laws* of 1935.

Another incident that left an incredibly profound impression on me is the ordeal experienced by the Japanese historian Sokichi Tsuda during the World War (the so-called "Tsuda Incident" [津田事件]). Because the entire sequence of this event is easily verifiable even within China, I will not reiterate the details here. What utterly shocked me was that under the rule of Japanese Fascism, when Sokichi Tsuda and Shigeo Iwanami were indicted for violating the Publication Law, they were only sentenced to three and two months of imprisonment, respectively, and were even granted a two-year suspended sentence. Tsuda personally insisted on appealing, arguing that the grounds for the indictment were invalid, and by 1944, the case concluded with the charges being dropped.

This legal saga lasted for four years: indicted in 1940, found guilty in 1942, and acquitted in 1944. Throughout this entire process, legal procedures such as witnesses testifying in court were astonishingly conducted in a normal manner, and the personal freedom of both men was not restricted. Tsuda left Tokyo for Hiraizumi and did not return to Tokyo until after the war. Even though I am aware that the sociological doctrines officially endorsed by the Empire of Japan likely inherent a division between "exoteric" and "esoteric" teachings (显密之分), the Empire generally

maintained a basic respect for its intellectuals. However, the fact that its judicial system could operate relatively normally and independently during the most rampant era of Fascist dictatorship is completely unimaginable to a Chinese person like myself.

During the chaotic years in our country, persecuting dissident intellectuals to death did not require strict, sluggish legal procedures—in fact, it required no legal procedures whatsoever. The authorities simply resorted to home raids (抄家), public struggle sessions (批斗), and torturing them to death; it could be done as swiftly as the authorities desired. Therefore, at that time, I clearly realized something that fundamentally differs from the common perception of the United States' "glorious martial achievement" in successfully transforming Japan single-handedly. Japan's post-war democratic transition was evidently predicated on the fact that Japanese society *itself* already possessed ample conditions to accept such a transformation. The social foundation of a nation with nearly a hundred million people could not possibly have been altered by a mere few years of American military occupation.

For instance, the *Constitution of Japan* (the "Peace Constitution" [和平宪法]) currently implemented in Japan set an incredibly high moral tone, drastically differing from the previous Meiji Constitution [明治宪法]. Yet, its ability to gain widespread acceptance within Japanese society is inextricably linked to the society's intrinsic tradition of respecting the law. If we were to trace the origins of this tradition, it should probably be credited to the monumental legacy of the Japanese samurai, epitomized by figures like Yasutoki Hojo [北条泰时]!

By the first half of 2023, I was able to clearly recognize that the rise of Fascism in Germany, Italy, and Japan was essentially the result of these three countries starting late, where their industry and capitalism had achieved considerable development but remained insufficient. The "insufficient development" here encompasses two aspects. First, the old feudal nobility domestically still retained substantial power and played a crucial role in politics. Second, due to their late industrialization, they essentially missed the wave of imperialist partition of the world; lacking overseas colonies, they consequently had scarce access to raw material sources and captive markets within their spheres of influence. Both forms of insufficiency are the result of the transition from the **early modern period** (近世社会) to modern society occurring far too late in these three nations.

One can easily observe that it was evidently no coincidence that Germany, Italy, and Japan formed the Axis powers. Formally speaking, the unification of these three countries occurred practically within the span of a single year: the unification of Italy in 1870, the unification of Germany in early 1871, and the abolition of the han system and establishment of prefectures (废藩置县) in Japan in mid-1871. The primary reason Germany and Italy unified so late was that, during the late Middle Ages, relatively strong central governments did not exist in these two countries, and since the end of the Middle Ages, they were frequently subjected to interference by neighboring, already centralized early modern absolute monarchies.

As for why Japan's **early modern period** persisted into the latter half of the 19th century, the main reason is that Japan's Middle Ages (中世社会) intrinsically ended later than Europe's. Furthermore, as the sole feudal state in Asia, Japan was excessively isolated. (This means that even if the total size of the East Asian market was no smaller than the European market back then, it was exceedingly difficult for Japan to achieve development by interacting with an increasingly capitalizing market, as it was possible for European nations. This was because China, the core of East Asia, was a **restoration-bureaucratic state** [复辟官僚国家], and the situation in Korea, under

Chinese influence, was equally unoptimistic.) Coupled with distinct religious and cultural differences from Europe, Japan maintained a long-term isolationist policy (锁国) under the generally conservative atmosphere of East Asia.

Nevertheless, regardless of the circumstances, these three countries had all fully traversed the stage of a *feudal society* (封建阶级社会) and possessed the characteristics of an *early modern society*. Consequently, there were no intrinsic, endogenous obstacles in their path to realizing modernization—a situation vastly different from that of Russia and China. In our country's political discourse, among the numerous characteristics of Fascism strongly emphasized, the concept of "class conciliation" (阶级调和) is one of the rare arguments in our official doctrines over the years that warrants the praise of "hitting the nail on the head." Fascist states often strenuously dilute internal class contradictions within a nation, advocate for supra-class nationalism, and declare that the enemy of the state is a particular foreign regime or a specific ethnicity.

If we consider that during the political unification process of Germany, Italy, and Japan—which was fraught with compromises—a massive number of feudal nobles still managed to play significant roles in national politics, then this point becomes much easier to comprehend. What the Fascist states sought to conciliate was evidently not just the ruled classes and the ruling classes; they also needed to conciliate factions *within* the ruling class itself. If we also consider that the absolute monarchy was established upon such an "equilibrium during the transition of classes," then Fascism is indeed the long shadow trailing behind the absolute monarchy state. Even today, there remains a theory within Japanese academia that views the Meiji Restoration as the establishment of Japan's absolute monarchy state; however, I still lean toward viewing Japan's early modern state, namely the Tokugawa Shogunate [德川幕府], as Japan's absolute monarchy.

The disposable wealth, level of education, and contemplation of the world they lived in possessed by ordinary citizens in Germany, Italy, and Japan at the dawn of the 20th century were incomparable to those of several centuries prior. The proletariat had indeed awakened, increasingly possessing the power and willingness to express their viewpoints and achieve their objectives. Therefore, when Fascist states emphasized "class conciliation" (阶级调和), they were compelled to claim that even the workers and peasants at the bottom of society were objects of conciliation, or even the primary objects. This paradoxically makes it easy for observers to overlook the conciliation between the old and new ruling classes.

Furthermore, since Fascist states did not wish to use class as a criterion for dividing society, and their level of social development was insufficient to sustain long-term, universal social welfare, they had to pin their hopes on a national policy capable of generating rapid returns to satisfy the interest demands of various domestic classes and strata—namely, external warfare. Conveniently, externalizing conflicts (转移矛盾) could effectively divert the attention of all domestic strata. This is consistent with the fact that after major European powers generally transitioned into *absolute monarchies* (绝对主义国家), the scale, frequency, and intensity of wars on the European continent rose drastically. It is just that the Fascist dictatorial system, unlike the absolute monarchy state, possessed no possibility of long-term endurance.

This is because the technological level of the 20th century was entirely incomparable to that of two or three centuries prior; the speed of information dissemination, the total volume of trade, the destructive power of war, and the degree of ordinary people's political participation had elevated exponentially. Once a Fascist state entered a state of war readiness, it inevitably faced a "total war"

(总体战争) surrounded by enemies on all sides; it would either be annihilated in this war or utterly defeat all its adversaries. Even if a Fascist state were to miraculously defeat all its enemies, the factors hindering the full development of capitalism within the country itself would have completely vanished. This victorious empire would possess colonies, markets, industrial facilities, and skilled workers at its disposal. Coupled with the fact that there would be no places left in the world worth conquering, the Fascist dictatorship would lose its viability to persist, and the Fascist state would transition into a normal capitalist regime.

Once the need for class conciliation disappeared, there would be no necessity for the entire nation to heavily emphasize racism, thereby avoiding unnecessary troubles. This is much like how one should not forget that while the genocide committed by Nazi Germany is a heinous crime forever worth remembering, did not the British Empire, the French colonial empire, the Kingdom of the Netherlands, the Kingdom of Belgium, and the United States of America harbor racist ideologies and actions prior to the Nazis? Did these nations not slaughter vulnerable ethnicities? For an individual, emphasizing a sense of morality is paramount; but for a massive society, its collective moral framework is also constructed upon social realities. The changes in the actual conditions confronting social development are the decisive reasons behind the gradual ebb of racism in these nations. A Fascist state would inevitably discard the Fascist system after achieving victory, much like how monarchs during Europe's period of absolute monarchy dared to proclaim "I am the state" (朕即国家), yet once the power of the bourgeoisie gained a distinct advantage and the class equilibrium could no longer be maintained, the kings of England and France had their heads severed.

Fascist states were in the exact same predicament, except that the tempo of everything in the 20th-century world had become far faster than before; thus, even if they had won, this transition would have occurred much more swiftly. In today's world, there are many alternate history works (架空作品)—whether literature, film, television, or game mods—premised on Germany and Japan winning the Second World War. They overwhelmingly tend to assume that the Fascist dictatorship would persist after the Fascist regimes secured victory in the global war. This contradicts the laws of social development. Of course, one could argue that maintaining this assumption is necessary to attract readers and players. After all, if Germany and Japan finished fighting the world war and then simply normalized, initiating a Cold War between themselves, it would obviously be too similar to the world we actually experienced to arouse the interest of potential audiences.

Therefore, I must point out that although the German, Italian, and Japanese Fascists were the initiators of the World War and the culpable parties for its war crimes, this certainly does not mean that these three nations were at the most backward societal stage. By comparison, the Soviet Union, as a major participant, was perhaps the most backward party (in fact, the term "backward" is inaccurate, as the stage the Soviet Union occupied was not on the normal developmental trajectory of humanity; like the Chinese empire (中华帝国), it was completely deformed). For all of humanity, even if Germany, Italy, and Japan had actually secured victory in the Second World War, human development might only have been delayed by a few decades. However, had the Soviet side actually achieved victory in the Cold War, it would have likely meant the termination of human civilization (人类文明的终结).

3, 对德、日“法西斯国家”的看法

我在这里采用的说法显然是具有争议的，中国大陆会笼统地把三个主要的轴心国都称为“法西斯国家”，但其实大部分人都知道，日本和真正的法西斯国家还有相当差距。这种问题的存在是必然的，日本的封建化进程开始的时间就显著晚于欧洲西部，虽然在绝大部分时期日本追赶的速度很快。然而在近世阶段日本因为所处地理位置相对孤立，它的邻国们是复辟官僚国家，日本的社会发展受到了一定阻碍。到20世纪上半叶，日本所具有的“现代性”，即现代社会所具有的独特的社会、文化、政治和经济特征，还是要比德国和意大利少。于是在极端民族主义，法西斯政党专政，个人独裁，群众性和统一法西斯主义意识形态这些特征方面，1931到1945年间的日本很难说是一个真正的法西斯国家。无论当年的日本与德国、意大利之间存在什么样的差距，都不妨碍我在这里把它们进行一体的讨论，即这三个国家样式不同的“法西斯政权”都是在完整经历了封建化过程，但是资本主义发展不充分的条件下形成的，所以在归类上不再做区分，而采用中国大陆的一般说法。

对于世界各地的少年而言，当他们的三观还很不成熟的时候，最感兴趣的历史恐怕就是人类的战争史和那些在战争中立下卓越功勋的英雄的故事了，我自然也不例外。关于第二次世界大战的小说也好，参战的将领、领导人的回忆录也好，甚至小孩子最喜欢的军事装备图鉴也罢，读了确实是不少。可是随着年龄的增长，当我自己的认识水平逐渐提升的时候，关于二次大战产生的疑惑就越来越多。一个最典型的例子就是德国和日本即使是在法西斯进行恐怖统治的时期，也展现出了与苏联和中国（现政权）社会截然不同的特征，当我对于中国社会越来越了解的时候，这种差别就不可避免地为我所注意。例如在纳粹德国，即使是部长这一级别的高官，只要他有一个博士学位，那么他也要在自己的头衔中加上“博士”。其中最具有代表性的毫无疑问是希特勒的忠实拥趸，纳粹德国最有权势的头几个人之一，保罗约瑟夫戈培尔，即使是在汉语的翻译中，一般也将他称为“纳粹德国国民教育与宣传部长戈培尔博士”。虽然我哪怕完全不懂德语没去过德国也知道德国的学位特别是博士学位极为难得，可即使这样这些纳粹高级官僚对于自己博士学位的看重和骄傲感也让我极其吃惊。在诸如苏联和中国这样的“党官僚”国家，虽然不能说学历没有作用，然而在官僚体制内的地位对于社会财富分配起到决定性作用的环境下，学位在官位面前是完全不值一提的。按照我国官僚社会约定俗成的习惯，即使是在科长这一级别，博士就已经难以作为主头衔了，这就是说如果一个中国官僚体制内的科级干部同时具有博士这一学位，那么人们对他的称呼大概率是“某科长”，只有在特定条件下才会强调这个人的博士学位。对于科级以上那就更不用说，只有在官方的介绍里面会优先给出学习经历和最高学位，但事实上未必有人注意也没什么人真正将其当一回事。这某种意义上也是因为官僚的支配权下当然包括了学位，在我们和前苏联这样的国家，只要你已经成为高级官僚，那么获得一个学位简直没有难度。只不过比较可笑的是，因为在这些国家学历本来也没受到什么尊重，有些人即使有权也懒得去弄一个学位装点门面。正是随着我社会经验有所增长，我才越来越感到像戈培尔这样看重自己学历的行为实在是太过奇怪了（当然我清楚真正奇怪的是我自己，比起德国，哪怕是比起纳粹统治时期的德国，我所处的社会才是更为异常的）。

日本作为近代以来给中国带来最大侵略伤害的两个国家之一（另一个是俄国），又是在整个反法西斯战争中与我国交战的对手，中国民间对于法西斯日本的讨论远远多于纳粹德国。然而非常可悲的事情是，比起中国人应当采取的反日本法西斯不反日本的态度，显然我的同胞更喜欢反日本不反法西斯。日本侵略者在所谓“大东亚战争”时期狂热的宣传口号以及少壮派军官独走的行为在躁动无知的同龄人中广受追捧，实际上，只要我打开以年轻用户为主的网络平台，那么刷不到五分钟肯定就会遇到这种弱智文章或者视频。我虽然感到厌烦，但是如此大量的信息轰炸也使得我逐渐意识到法西斯日本这个中国人最憎恨的政权竟然也存在一些我之前不曾注意过的，与中苏之流的国家截然不同的特征，那就是日本人竟然如此敬畏法律，哪怕是在战后的民主改革之前就已经如此了。其中最鲜明的表现就是《大日本帝国宪法》（或者通俗的称呼“明治宪法”）在于1889年初正式颁布之后直到战后被“和平宪法”取代之前没有任何实质性修订，日本政府仅仅对于个别条款的解释和实施进行过调整。这就意味着即使是在日本军部权势熏天，大政翼赞会这样的法西斯政治团体能够左右国家政治以及日本帝国侵略战争迅速扩大的时期，日本法西斯竟然不试图去进行修宪，而仅仅是通过追加各种战时法令来强化自己对全国的控制。在臭名昭著的“二二六兵变”期间，面对发动政变的皇道派少壮军官对于天皇应当绕开“国贼”实施亲政的要求，裕仁天皇居然也对政变表示极其愤怒，并强调自己在明治宪法体制下实现“万机御亲裁”就已经是亲政了，不存在别的什么形式的亲政。

如果一个人不同时了解中国和日本的历史，就很难对我作为一个在中国长期生活的人对此感到的极度震惊有所理解，在我国统治者对于这样的“保皇政变”不加以利用反倒当即决定镇压是非常难以想象的。如果还不能理解日本社会的这种“怪异”，只需要观察一下现在在第三世界广大非民主国家仍然存在的宪法毫无约束力的现象，看看这些国家想要修宪是多么容易。至于苏联式和苏联式的国家就更不用说了，这些政权制定的宪法可以说是想怎么改就怎么改，想宣布自己越过了哪个阶段就越过了哪个阶段，想声称什么思想是指导思想就声称什么思想是指导思想。甚至当我们把目光局限在那个风起云涌的年代里崛起的法西斯国家或者极右翼国家，日本原有宪法所受到破坏的程度依然算是小的（当然这与明治维新的不彻底也有关系，毕竟明治宪法中天皇的权力就已经很大了）：萨拉查统治下的葡萄牙在1933年制定了新宪法，罗马尼亚在1938年制定了新宪法，霍尔蒂摄政的匈牙利缺少正式的宪法文本，弗朗哥统治下的西班牙没有制定新宪法，保加利亚沙皇国对独立之初的宪法进行了修正。墨索里尼统治下的意大利没有废除原有宪法（原先撒丁王国时期制定的宪法），但实际终止实施，并通过附加法令使其法西斯化。希特勒统治下的第三帝国大幅修改了原有的魏玛共和国宪法，并且通过一系列法案例如1933年的《授权法案》，1934年的《国家元首法》，1935年的《纽伦堡法案》逐渐实现了法西斯专政。

另一个令我印象极为深刻的事件则是日本历史学者津田左右吉在二战期间的遭遇（即所谓“津田事件”），因为该事件即使在国内也很容易查到来龙去脉，所以我不再赘述。让我感到极度震惊的是，在日本法西斯统治下津田左右吉和岩波茂雄因触犯出版法而被起诉，竟然只被分别判处三个月和两个月的有期徒刑，还缓刑两年。津田本人以起诉理由不成立坚持提起上诉，到1944年这个案件以免起诉收场。这一事件持续了四年，40年起诉，42年两人被判有罪，44年被免诉，在整个过程中诸如证人出庭作证这样的法律程序居然在正常进行，两人的自由也没有受到限制，津田离开东京前往平泉，直到战后才返回东京。哪怕我知道旧日本帝国官方认可的社会学说大概本来就有“显”“密”之分，帝国对于知识分子总体上还是尊重的。但是在法西斯专政最猖獗的年代，其司法系统居然还能相对正常和独立地运作，这在我这样的中国人看来是完全不可想象的。在我国的混乱年岁里，整死持异见的知识分子不要说走严格的、缓慢的法律程序，甚至就不需要任何法律程序，直接抄家、批斗、折磨致死就了事，想多快就能办到多快。因此我那个时候就清晰地意识到，显然不同于一般人认知的美国凭一己之力成功改造日本的“赫赫武功”，日本战后所发生的民主转型显然是基于日本社会本身就有充分的接受这种变革的条件的基础上，一个人口近亿的国家所具有的社会基础不可能是美国人短短几年的军事占领就能够改变的。例如日本现在所实行的《日本国宪法》（和平宪法）调子起得如此之高，与之前的明治宪法差别如此之大，却在日本社会能够受到广泛的认可，本身就与日本社会有尊重法律的传统密不可分。如果要追溯起来，这大概是以北条泰时为代表的日本武士之功勋吧！

到2023年上半年，我已经能够清晰地认识到所谓德意日法西斯的崛起，本质上是这三个国家起步较晚，工业和资本主义得到了相当发展但是又不够充分所导致的结果。这里的“发展不充分”包括两个方面，其一是指在国内旧封建贵族仍然具有较大势力，在政治中起到重要作用，其二是指因为工业化晚，又基本上错过了帝国主义瓜分世界的浪潮，在国外缺乏殖民地，因而少有原材料产地和势力范围内的市场。这两种不充分都属于三个国家从近世向近现代的演变发生太晚的结果，人们很容易注意到德意日三个国家形成轴心国显然并非偶然，这三个国家的统一从形式上看甚至就是一年之内发生的事情，1870年意大利统一，1871年初德意志统一，1871年中日本废藩置县。德国和意大利统一较晚主要原因在这两国在中世纪后期的时候就不存在相对强力的中央政府，中世纪结束以来又频繁受到邻近的已经中央集权化的近世绝对主义国家进行干涉。至于日本的近世之所以会延续到19世纪后半叶，主要还是因为日本的中世社会本来结束的就比欧洲晚，日本作为亚洲唯一的封建国家太过孤立（这意味着即使当年东亚市场的总规模并不小于欧洲市场，但是日本很难像欧洲国家一样在与一个日益资本主义化的市场互动中取得发展，因为作为东亚主体的中国属于复辟官僚国家，朝鲜在中国的影响下情况一样不乐观），与欧洲在宗教和文化上又有明显差别，在东亚整体保守的氛围下长期锁国。然而，无论如何这三个国家都已经完整经过了封建阶级社会这一阶段，具有近世社会的特征，因而在实现近现代化的问题上不存在内源性的本质阻碍，这与俄国和中国的情况差别极大。在我国的政治语境中相当强调法西斯主义的众多特征中

“阶级调和”这一特点，这可以说是我这么多年见到的我国官方学说中少有的可以说让人说上一句“此言得之”的论点了。法西斯国家往往极力弱化一国内部的阶级矛盾，鼓吹超阶级的国家主义，并宣称国家之敌是某一个外国政权或者是某一民族。如果我们考虑到德意日三国在充满妥协的政治统一过程中依然使得大量封建贵族在国家政治中扮演重要角色，那么这一点就更容易理解了，法西斯国家所想调和的显

然不只是被统治阶级和统治阶级，它也需要调和统治阶级内部。如果我们考虑到绝对主义国家也建立在这种“阶级交替时的平衡”之一，那么法西斯的确就是绝对主义国家拖在身后长长的阴影。即使是在现在，日本学界仍然有把明治维新视为日本绝对主义国家建立的说法，只不过我还是倾向于把日本的近世国家即德川幕府视为日本的绝对主义国家。

20 世纪初的德意日普通百姓所拥有的可支配财富，受教育程度以及对自身所处世界的思考都不是早几个世纪时所能比拟的，无产阶级确实觉醒了，并且越来越有力量和意愿去表达自己的观点和实现自己的目的。因此当法西斯国家强调阶级调和的时候，他就不得不声称即使是处于社会底层的工农也属于调和的对象，甚至是首要的对象，这反而使得观察者容易忽视新旧统治阶级之间的调和。而既然法西斯国家不希望采取阶级这种标准来对社会进行划分，其社会发展程度又不足以支撑长期的、普遍的社会福利，那么法西斯国家为了满足国内各个阶级（阶层）的利益诉求，就不得不寄希望于一种有希望快速回本的国策，那就是对外战争，顺便把矛盾转移到外部也能够有效吸引国内各个阶层的注意力。这与欧洲大国普遍进入绝对主义国家之后，欧洲大陆上战争的规模，频率和烈度大幅上升是一致的。只不过法西斯专政体制不同于绝对主义国家，不存在长期持续的可能罢了。

这是因为 20 世纪的技术水平是两三个世纪前完全无法比拟的，信息传播的速度，贸易的总额，战争的破坏力或是普通人民参与政治的程度已经提升了太多太多。法西斯国家一旦进入战备，就不可能不面临一场四面皆敌的总体战争，它要么在这场战争中被毁灭，要么彻底打败所有的敌人。即使法西斯国家能够侥幸击败所有敌人，那么对于它本身而言，阻碍这个国家资本主义充分发展的因素就彻底消失了。这个战胜了帝国要殖民地有殖民地，要市场有市场，要工业设施有工业设施，要技术工人有技术工人。再加上世上已经没有值得去征服的地方，法西斯专政即没有维持下去的可能，法西斯国家也会向一个正常资本主义政权转变。一旦阶级调和的需求消失，整个国家也没有必要在如此强调种族主义以避免不必要的麻烦。就如同人们不应该忘记虽然说纳粹德国的种族灭绝是永远值得铭记的滔天罪行，但是在纳粹之前大英帝国，法兰西殖民帝国，荷兰王国，比利时王国和美利坚合众国难道就不存在种族主义思想和种族主义行为？难道这些国家就没有对弱势民族进行屠杀？对个人而言，强调道德感是非常重要的，但是对一个庞大的社会来说，其整体的道德观念也是基于社会现实建立，社会发展面临的实际情况的变化才是这些国家种族主义逐渐退潮的决定性原因。法西斯国家在得胜后必然抛弃法西斯制度，就好比欧洲绝对主义时期的君主敢于声称“朕即国家”，但是一旦资产阶级的力量取得明显优势，阶级平衡无法维持的时候，英国和法国的国王就被砍掉了脑袋。

法西斯国家也处于一样的境地，只不过 20 世纪的世界所有事情的节奏都变得比以往更快，因此它即便取胜这种转变也会更为迅速。当今世界存在许多假定德国和日本取得二次大战的架空作品，不管是文学作品影视作品还是游戏模组，都非常倾向于假设法西斯专政在法西斯政权取得世界大战胜利之后仍然存在，这是不符合社会发展规律的。当然也可以说，只有维持这种假定才能够吸引读者和玩家，毕竟如果德国和日本打完世界大战然后又正常化了，这两个国家开始冷战，那显然跟我们真实经历的世界就过于相似，无法激起潜在读者的兴趣罢了。因此我必须指出，尽管德意日法西斯是世界大战的发起者，战争罪行的责任方，但是这确实不代表这三个国家处于的社会阶段最为落后。相比之下，作为主要参与方的苏联或许才是最为落后的一方（实际上落后这一词不准确，因为苏联所处的阶段并不在人类正常的发展路径上，它和中华帝国一样完全是畸形的）。对于全人类来说，就算德意日在二次大战中真的取得胜利，那么人类的发展或许会推迟几十年；但是如果苏联一方在冷战中真的取得胜利，那么这恐怕是人类文明的终结。